FUELING AND MAINTENANCE PRECAUTIONS

Observe all safety regulations on the safe handling of fuel. When necessary to refuel, comply with the following:

1. The saw should never be refueled while the engine is running.
2. If fuel is spilled while refueling, wipe off saw before starting.
3. Do not operate the saw if there is a fuel leak. Send it in for servicing.
4. Do not restart the saw in a small-enclosed space after refueling.

Always keep equipment in good, clean, serviceable condition.

Examine the rescue saw cutting wheel for nicks or defects at the beginning of each shift and after each use.

Clean the wheel (blade) and both wheel washers when installing the wheel. Wheel blotters must be used between washers and wheel to compensate for irregularities in the wheel.

Care must be taken to assure that the abrasive saw blades do not become contaminated with petroleum based products. Such contamination may dissolve the resin which is used to bond the blade, causing the blade to shatter when used. New blades should be stored in plastic bags to insure cleanliness.

Guideline: 607.03 Battery Rescue Tool

Full protective clothing shall be worn by those members operating, or in close proximity to the operation of the Battery Rescue Tool.

The batteries used to operate the Rescue Tool can cause damage to the eyes if not maintained. To provide eye protection, allowing for the event of a battery failure where fluid could be expelled, all members in the area of operation of a Rescue Tool shall place their goggles in the down position to provide for such protection.

Precautions shall be taken to protect the trapped and injured from further injuries during the operation (i.e. sparks, propelled objects, flying glass, etc.), and a charged 1½" foam hose line in place, manned by personnel in full protective clothing.

The purpose of the Protective Clothing Inspection Program is to establish a system to regularly inspect protective clothing and equipment assigned to its members, and to set standards for the maintenance of these items.

Effective January 1, 2024, Calimesa Fire Department shall implement the NFPA 1851 standards for issuance, inspection, decontamination, and cleaning. The PPE program shall be overseen by a Battalion Chief, Fire Captain and Firefighter for scheduling, inventory control and program management.

It is the guideline of the Calimesa Fire Department to provide its members with protective clothing and equipment to safeguard them from injury when involved in Fire Department activity. The protective clothing and equipment shall be appropriate for the various activities and services the Fire Department members may provide.

This inspection is intended to assure that all personnel are provided with a complete set of protective clothing and equipment, maintained in safe and functional condition. Along with the inspection the company will fill out the Protective Clothing Inspection Form. (Form #402.15)

Protective clothing inspections will use the following inspection criteria to evaluate the condition of protective clothing. Each item will be rated in at least one of the five categories:

- Satisfactory
- Clean
- Repair
- Replace
- Missing Item

The company officers are responsible for the management of protective clothing and equipment inspections and adherence to requirements in their designated shift.

The company officer shall verify proper fit of turnout coats and pants while the clothing is actually being worn by the firefighter when conducting the inspection. Protective hoods shall be inspected with SCBA facepiece in place and hood on to verify proper fit and coverage of all facial and neck skin surfaces.

Each member of the Fire Department is responsible for inspecting his/her protective clothing daily, as well as for the cleaning, care and maintenance of all issued protective equipment. The individual member is responsible for obtaining repairs or replacement items, when needed, by following established guidelines.

The company officer will determine the time allowable for correction of any deficiency. This shall not exceed 7 days in any circumstance. Protective clothing or equipment that will not provide adequate protection shall be replaced immediately. Personnel will not be permitted to engage in operations in the absence of, or with seriously deficient, protective equipment.

Protective equipment needing replacement will be exchanged with Resource Management at the earliest opportunity. The company officer may have certain replacement items to issue immediately.

Missing items require a Lost, Stolen or Damaged Report. The company officer must fill out Form# 402.14.

Only protective clothing issued or approved by the Calimesa Fire Department shall be worn. Protective clothing will not be modified without the approval of the Safety Officer.

HELMETS

Helmets shall be maintained reasonably clean with proper company numbers in place. Goggles, chin strap, earflaps and suspension shall be in good condition.

1. Cleaning:
    a. Helmets should be cleaned with hot tap water and mild (household) detergent.
    b. The following is a list of additional cleaning materials which can be used to remove stubborn dirt and smoke stains:
        i. Isopropyl Alcohol (rubbing alcohol)
        ii. Windex (regular, not ammoniated)
        iii. Dishwashing Detergent
        iv. DuPont Wash-wax
    c. Do not use other materials such as strong (industrial strength) detergents, solvents, petroleum products, etc. These will damage the shell and face shield, and reduce the protective capability of the helmet.
2. Repair:
    a. Missing nuts face shield adapters.
    b. Face shield excessively scratched.
    c. Chin strap and assembly broken or torn.
    d. Helmet liner worn, shredded, split, cracked or blistered.
    e. Webbed suspensions broken.
    f. Company numbers missing or wrong.
3. Replace:
    a. Severely stained or split facepiece.

b. Helmet with visible cracks.
c. Helmet that is warped or bubbled from exposure to heat.
d. Helmet that has been exposed to mist or fumes which are known to weaken polycarbons.

NOTE: All items constructed from thermoplastics are susceptible to ultraviolet and chemical degradation. When the helmet loses its surface gloss and the surface begins to flake away, this chemical degradation has occurred. During inspections, helmets will be checked for these conditions and the shell will be replaced immediately if they are evident.

PROTECTIVE HOOD

1. Cleaning:
   a. Use warm water and any mild detergent.
2. Replace:
   a. Hoods that have holes or tears in them.
   b. Hoods that are not Fire Department approved.
   c. Hoods stretched out of shape and/or do not provide coverage of all face or neck skin surfaces.
   d. Hoods that have burn discoloration.

PERSONAL IDENTIFICATION NAME TAGS

The personal identification nametag will be checked. Obtain or replace missing or damaged nametags. Five tags per firefighter are required.

GLOVES

1. Cleaning:
   a. Use warm water and mild detergent.
2. Replace:
   a. Stiff or rigid gloves.
   b. Stitching worn or rotten.
   c. Glove insulation is worn through.
   d. Leather split.
   e. Gloves with holes or tears in them.
   f. Gloves that do not fit properly.
   g. Gloves that are not Fire Department approved.

TURNOUT COAT & PANTS

1. Cleaning:
    a. Liners and shell can be washed with mild detergent.
    b. Heavily soiled spots can be removed with general spot cleaners.
2. Repairs:
    a. All repairs requiring stitching must be made with Nomex thread by a vender.
    b. Rivets pulled loose from fabric and from the objects they secure.
    c. Suspenders, snaps, and leather eyes that are broken or elongated.
    d. Stitching missing.
    e. Holes or rips in shell of garment.
    f. Frayed or worn collars.
    g. Ripped liners.
    h. Reflective stripes that are burned cracked, melted or torn.
    i. Wristlets that are torn or stretched.
3. Replace:
    a. Coats and pants on which the stitching is damaged beyond repair.
    b. Coats and pants on which the fabric is worn through.
    c. Coats and pants soiled to the point they cannot be cleaned, or saturated with oil, tar, etc.
    d. Coats with charring or evidence of other fire damage.
    e. Improper fitting coats - i.e. sleeves too short.

BOOTS

Inspect the rubber boots that are part of the turnout pants.

Replace:

1. Boots that are severely cracked.
2. Boots with any holes in them.
3. Improper fitting boots.
4. Obvious excessive tread wear.

FLASHLIGHT

Each firefighter's flashlight shall be checked for operation. Flashlights that do not work will be replaced or repaired

Guideline: 607.06 SCBA Cleaning

The SCBA Cleaning Guideline is put in place to provide direction on decontamination of Self Contained Breathing Apparatus (SCBA) after use to protect all staff from dangerous contaminates or particles that can cause serious health and safety issues.

All SCBA system components shall be decontaminated with mild soap and water. After decontamination, the SCBA shall be placed in an upright position and to allow air drying before it is placed back in service.

The SCBA decontamination guide shall be utilized on all SCBAs after they have been subjected to fire, smoke and Haz Mat Environments.

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The Dispatch Center will dispatch the appropriate Hazardous Materials Assignment Companies to all reported hazardous materials incidents.

FIRST ARRIVING UNIT

The first arriving officer will establish Command and begin a size-up. The first unit must consciously avoid committing itself to a dangerous situation. When approaching slow down or stop to assess any visible activity taking place. Evaluate effects of wind, topography and location of the situation. Route any other responding companies away from any hazards.

Command should consider establishing level II staging whenever possible for other responding units. Staged companies must be in a safe location taking into account wind, spill flow, explosion potential and similar factors in any situation. The dot guidebook, NFPA reference materials, the NIOSH Pocket Guide (NPG), or any other material such as MSDS or shipping papers available to them should be used to establish a safe distance for staging.

SIZE-UP

Command must make a careful size-up before making a commitment. It may be necessary to take immediate action to make a rescue or evacuate an area. This should be attempted only after a risk/benefit analysis is completed. Personnel must take advantage of available personal protective equipment in these situations.

The objective of the size-up is to identify the nature and severity of the immediate problem and to gather sufficient information to formulate a valid action plan. Hazardous materials incidents require a cautious and deliberate size-up.

Avoid premature commitment of companies and personnel to potentially hazardous locations. Proceed with caution in evaluating risks before formulating a plan and keep uncommitted companies at a safe distance. In many cases evaluation by hazardous materials team members before committing is the safest approach.

Identify a hazardous area based on potential danger, taking into account materials involved, time of day, wind and weather conditions, location of the incident and degree of risk to unprotected personnel. Take immediate action to evacuate and/or rescue persons in critical danger, if possible, providing for safety of rescuers first.

The primary objective is to identify the type of materials involved in a situation and the hazards presented before formulating a plan of action. Look for labels, markers, DOT Identification Numbers, NFPA Diamond or shipping papers, etc.

Refer to pre-fire plans and ask personnel at the scene for additional information (plant management, responsible party, truck drivers, fire department specialist). Use reference materials carried on apparatus and have Dispatch contact other sources for assistance in sizing up the problem (state agencies, fire department specialists, manufacturers of materials, etc.).

ACTION PLAN

Based on the initial size-up and any information available Command will formulate an action plan to deal with the situation.

The Action Plan must provide for:

- Safety of all fire personnel
- Evacuation of endangered area if necessary
- Control of situation
- Stabilization of hazardous materials and/or
- Disposal or removal of hazardous material

Most hazardous materials should be maintained in a safe condition for handling and use through confinement in a container or protective system. The emergency is usually related to the material escaping from the protective container or system and creating a hazard on the exterior.

The strategic plan must include a method to control the flow or release, get the hazardous material back into a safe container, neutralize it, allow it to dissipate safely, or coordinate proper disposal.

The specific action plan must identify the method of hazard control and identify the resources necessary to accomplish this goal. It may be necessary to select one method over another due to the unavailability of a particular resource or to adopt a "holding action" to wait for needed equipment or supplies.

Avoid committing personnel and equipment prematurely or "experimenting" with techniques and tactics. Many times it is necessary to evacuate and wait for special equipment or technical help.

As a general policy, the Hazardous Materials Team will respond to any situation where a private contractor is required to clean-up hazardous materials.

CONTROL OF HAZARDOUS AREA

A hazardous material incident has two initial zones associated with the scene similar to a fire. There are the HOT ZONE and the WARM ZONE.

HOT ZONE

The hot zone is the area in which personnel are potentially in immediate danger from the hazardous condition. This is established by Command and controlled by the Fire Department.

Access to this area will be rigidly controlled and only personnel with proper protective equipment and an assigned activity will enter.

All companies will remain intact in designated staging areas until assigned. Personnel will be assigned to monitor entry and exit of all personnel from the hot zone.

The hot zone should be geographically described to all responding units if possible and identified by yellow fire line tape. A Safety Officer will establish control access to the hot zone and maintain an awareness of which personnel are working in the area.

- Establish a safe perimeter around hazardous area and identify with Hazard Zone tape.
- Request adequate assistance to maintain the perimeter.
- Identify an entrance/exit point and inform Command of its location.
- Coordinate with Safety Officer to identify required level of protection for personnel operating in the Hot Zone.
- Collect/return accountability passports of all companies entering/leaving the controlled area.

Restriction of personnel access into the Hot Zone includes not only Fire Department personnel but also any others who may wish to enter the Hot Zone (Police, press, employees, tow truck drivers, ambulance personnel, etc.). Command is responsible for everyone's safety.

WARM ZONE

The Warm Zone is the larger area surrounding the Hot Zone in which a lesser degree of risk to personnel exists. All civilians would be removed from this area. The limits of this zone will be enforced by the Police Department based on distances and directions established in consultation with Command. The area to be evacuated depends on the nature and amount of the material and type of risk it presents to unprotected personnel (toxic, explosive, etc.).

In some cases it is necessary to completely evacuate a radius around a site for a certain distance (i.e., potential explosion). In other cases it may be advisable to evacuate a path downwind where toxic or flammable vapors may be carried (and control ignition sources in case of flammable vapors).

Reference: Safety Officer, Police Liaison Sector

NOTE: When toxic or irritant vapors are being carried downwind it may be most effective to keep everyone indoors with windows and doors closed to prevent contact with the material instead of evacuating the area. In these cases companies will be assigned to patrol the area assisting citizens in shutting down ventilation systems and evacuating persons with susceptibility to respiratory problems.

In all cases the responsibility for safety of all potentially endangered citizens' rests with Command. Once the Hazardous Materials Sector has been established, Haz Mat personnel will define and establish a hot, warm and cold zone. These zones will remain in effect for the remainder of the incident.

BE AWARE THAT COMMAND IS RESPONSIBLE FOR THE SAFETY OF ALL PERSONNEL INVOLVED IN ANY INCIDENT

An incident involving hazardous materials has a higher probability of causing an evacuation of an affected area than any other incident. By the very nature of the hazard this type of evacuation often provides very little preparation time. Decisions will need to be made quickly and citizens moved rapidly.

This procedure identifies the method and resources required to execute a small to large-scale evacuation.

LEVELS OF EVACUATION

Experience has reflected three levels of evacuation. Each requires a different resource commitment. They include, Site Evacuation, Intermediate Level Evacuation, and Large Scale Evacuation

SITE EVACUATION

Site evacuation involves a small number of citizens. This typically includes the workers at the site and persons from adjacent occupancies or areas. The citizens are easily evacuated and collected upwind at the perimeter area.

Evacuation holding times are typically short, generally less than an hour or two, and citizens are permitted to return to their businesses or homes.

INTERMEDIATE LEVEL EVACUATION

The next level or intermediate level involves larger numbers of citizens and/or affects a larger area. This level affects off-site homes and businesses and normally affects fewer than 100 persons.

Persons may remain out of the area for two to four hours or more. Evacuation completion times will be somewhat longer, but generally rapid. Collecting, documenting, and controlling the evacuees becomes more difficult.

Off-site collection sites or shelter areas will need to be determined and managed. Some evacuees will leave the area on their own or be sent home by employers. Site perimeters become larger and perimeter security requires more resource. Close coordination with the Police Department and other agencies will be required.

LARGE SCALE EVACUATION

A large or concentrated release of a hazardous substance may cause a large off-site evacuation. Thousands of citizens could be evacuated. Rapid initiation of the evacuation process may be required. Evacuees may be out of their homes and businesses for many hours if not days. Evacuation completion time frames will be extended.

Evacuation shelters will need to be located, opened and managed. Documentation and tracking of evacuees becomes more important as well as more difficult to manage. Very close coordination with the police and multiple agencies will be required.

Site and evacuation perimeters become extended and require much more resources to maintain. Security of the evacuated area becomes a concern.

TIME FACTOR CONSIDERATIONS

Time factors are also an important consideration in the evacuation decision.

A rapidly developing moving toxic cloud will demand a more immediate size-up and quick decision making. Such forced speed of decision making often is made with less information than a slow-moving event. Accuracy of information will also be limited.

The speed of the developing hazard will dictate the speed of evacuation. Immediate evacuation will require more resources than a slower developing event.

It will take time to complete the evacuation. The more people to be evacuated and the distance between the occupancies to be evacuated the more time required. The greater numbers needing evacuation will also require a greater resource commitment.

DECISION TO EVACUATE

The decision to evacuate needs to be considered quickly and early. Delays in initiating evacuations can expose greater numbers of the public to the hazardous product.

An unnecessary evacuation should be avoided however once the hazard has been identified and verified the process of deciding who, when, and how to evacuate should proceed quickly.

In some cases in-place sheltering (staying indoors) may provide adequate protection and should be a serious consideration in the decision-making process.

Factors to consider when evaluating the evacuation need include:

- Product Toxicity (as a health hazard)
- Concentrations (before it becomes a health hazard)
- Length of Time Exposed
- Weather Conditions (temperature, humidity)
- Wind Direction (direction, speed)
- Wind Changes
- Predicted Weather Changes
- Distances from Site Requiring Evacuation
- Evacuation Risk to Public (bringing them outdoors)
- Infiltration into Buildings
- Shelter Locations
- Transportation Needs and Availability
- Evacuation Time Factors
- Resources Required for Evacuation
- Concentrations of the population in the area

In some situations in-place sheltering can be used to protect the public rather than to initiate an evacuation.

In-place sheltering can be considered during the following circumstances:

- The hazardous material has been identified as having a low or moderate level health risk.
- The material has been released from its container and is now dissipating.
- Leaks can be controlled rapidly and before evacuation can be completed.
- Exposure to the product is expected to be short-term and of low health risk.
- Staying indoors can adequately protect the public.

Command may need to provide instructions to the affected public regarding the need to stay indoors and in such protective measures as shutting down their evaporative cooling systems, and sealing their buildings.

COMMAND ORGANIZATION

Once Command has determined evacuation to be necessary adequate resources need to be called to the scene and appropriate agencies notified to respond. A central staging area for all agencies should be considered.

The Incident Command Organization will need to be expanded to include other Branches. This level of Command structure may need to be implemented to more effectively manage a large-scale incident. Sections/Branches to be considered include:

- Public Information
- Geographic Multiple Branches
- Police Liaison
- Staging
- Transportation
- Police Resource
- Shelter
- Another Agency Liaison
    - Operations
    - Administrative
    - Planning
    - Logistics
- Evacuation Branch

COMMAND RESPONSIBILITIES

Command's responsibilities include the following items:

- Rapidly size up the situation to determine the need to evacuate.
- Determine evacuation perimeters.
- Determine the number and location of shelter sites and communicate the locations to the command organization.
- Order evacuation.
- Provide resources required
- Establish Police liaison.
- Order the alert of other appropriate agencies.
- Expand the command organization to meet the incident/evacuation needs.
- Establish an evacuation plan and communicate the plan to sectors and agency liaisons.
- Monitor, support, and revise the evacuation process as necessary.
- Evacuate persons from the area of greatest danger first.
- Assign specific areas to evacuate in order to avoid duplication or missed areas [use Fire Department map book.
- Provide the transportation necessary for evacuees.
- Provide continuing command of the evacuation, de-commitment, and return of evacuees.

POLICE RESPONSIBILITIES

The Police Department will be an integral part of the evacuation process as a large portion of the evacuation may be accomplished by police officers.

Police responsibilities include:

- Provide a ranking officer to the incident command post.
- Provide a ranking officer to the Evacuation Sector/Evacuations Branch.
- Provide a communication system for police resources.
- Provide police resources needed for evacuation.
- Provide traffic control and traffic routing.
- Provide perimeter security.
- Provide evacuation zone security.

PUBLIC INFORMATION OFFICER'S RESPONSIBILITIES

- Notify the news media and provide status reports and updates as necessary.
- Provide the media with consistent and accurate evacuation instructions as provided by Command or the Evacuation Branch.
- Utilize the media and coordinate evacuation notices through news media.

RED CROSS RESPONSIBILITIES

Once long term sheltering is identified the Red Cross will open and manage shelters. The Red Cross will need up to three hours to get adequate personnel, equipment and supplies to the shelter sites.

Some Fire Department resources may need to be committed to the shelters particularly in the area of initial opening and staffing by a shelter crew and later for potential emergency medical support.

EVACUATION BRANCH RESPONSIBILITIES

An Evacuation Branch must be established on large-scale evacuations. The Evacuation Branch should have a separate radio channel. Various sub-level sectors would also need to be established and report to Evacuation Branch.

Typically a large commitment of police officers will be required to accomplish an evacuation. The Evacuation Branch officer must obtain a ranking police officer at his/her location in order to closely coordinate evacuation efforts.

An appropriate commitment of police resource must be obtained. Evacuation responsibilities include:

- Obtain resource needed to evacuate.
- Obtain ranking police officer for liaison.
- Establish sectors as needed
- Provide objectives and specific areas to evacuate (use Fire Department map pages).
- Provide shelter location and instructions.
- Provide evacuation instruction pads.
- Provide private vehicle routing instructions (out of the area).
- Obtain/provide buses or other transportation to those requiring transportation out of the area. For large-scale evacuation start with two buses and request more as needed.
- Evacuate those at greatest risk first.
- Evacuate the greatest concentrated areas next (i.e., apartment complex).
- Consider individual sectors for large population occupancies (i.e., multi-story buildings, large apartment complexes, schools, etc.).
- As individual geographic or grid sectors complete their evacuations terminate the sector identity and reassign resources to other developing sectors (for large scale evacuation).
- Closely document and maintain records of the evacuation process to avoid duplication or missed areas.
- Document those addressees refusing to leave.

ON-SITE NOTIFICATION TO EVACUATE

Door-to-door notification is time-consuming. In many cases adequate resources and time is not available to do this type of face-to-face notification. Use of sirens, air horns and PA systems will speed the alert process.

When making door-to-door evacuations:

- Be in uniform.
- Wear your helmet.

Face-to-face notification should include the following instructions:

- There's been a hazardous materials incident.
- You are in danger.
- Leave immediately.
- Go to the shelter (location).
- Take (   ) route out of area.

- Do you need transportation?
- Provide the customer with evacuation instructions.

Take the following items:

- Wallet/purse
- House & car keys
- Money
- Eye glasses
- Medications
- Proper clothing
- Pets

In other situations where immediate and rapid evacuation makes door-to-door notification impossible use the following notification method:

- Use 3 five-second blasts of the siren while on the "YELP" setting.
- Followed by the standard evacuation instruction over PA system (see instructions above)
- Use maximum volume on PA system.
- Proceed slowly to maximize notification.
- Initiate notification at the beginning of each block and each 50 yards after that. Once each assigned grid of objectives is complete report completion to the Evacuation Branch officer.

REFUSAL TO LEAVE

Some citizens may refuse to leave. A few methods of persuasion to leave include:

- Be in uniform.
- Wear your helmet.
- Wear SCBA and facepiece (air hose may not need to be connected) when advising the citizen to leave.
- Ask for next of kin and a phone number.
- Write the next of kin information down.

Evacuations follow somewhat of a triage philosophy; we'll evacuate the greatest number for the greatest benefit. Individual refusals will be left to fend for themselves. There simply may not be enough time or resources to initiate forced removal of persons from their homes. However, documentation of the refusal should be done. Write the address down or if radio traffic permits radio the address to the Evacuation Branch Officer.

TRANSPORTATION SECTOR RESPONSIBILITIES

A Transportation Branch should be a priority consideration for any intermediate or large-scale evacuation. Not all citizens will have a vehicle available to them.

- Obtain buses (start with minimum of two) and other vehicles that can be used for transportation.
- Stage all transportation resources.
- Put one firefighter (or police officer) with a radio on each vehicle equipped with a Fire or Police Department radio.
- Coordinate with Evacuation Branch the pick-up points or addresses of those citizens needing transportation.

FIRE CHIEF

Any time more than ten (10) persons are evacuated the Fire Chief advises the City Manager or his/her designee of the situation.

If the Fire Chief cannot respond to the incident or is delayed the Deputy Fire Chief will need to contact the Incident Command Staff for a status report. Command should be prepared to respond to this request via cellular telephone, etc.

This guideline establishes a standard structure and procedure for all fire department personnel operating at incidents involving tree rescue operations. The guideline outlines responsibilities for first-responders, Command Officers, and other fire department personnel responding to such incidents.

Because tree rescue operations present a significant danger to fire department personnel the safe and effective management of these operations require special considerations. This procedure identifies some of the critical issues that must be included in managing these incidents.

TACTICAL CONSIDERATIONS

Due to the inherent dangers associated with these operations the Calimesa Fire Department Risk Management System shall be applied to all tree rescue operations and shall be continuously re-assessed throughout the incident. A phased approach to tree rescue operations which include arrival, pre-rescue operations, rescue operations and termination can be utilized to safely and effectively mitigate these high-risk / low-frequency events.

I. ARRIVAL

1. Establish Command
    a. First arriving Company Officer shall assume Command and begin an immediate size up of the situation.
    b. Designate a Safety Officer
2. Size-Up
    a. Secure a witness or responsible party to assist in gathering information to determine exactly what happened. If no witnesses are present Command may have to look for clues on the scene to determine what happened.
    b. Assess the immediate and potential hazards to the rescuers.
    c. Isolate immediate hazard area, secure the scene, and deny entry for all non-rescue personnel.
    d. Assess on-scene capabilities and determine the need for additional resources.
3. Pre-rescue Operations
    a. It must be determined if this will be a rescue operation or a recovery operation based on the survivability profile of the victim(s) which include factors such as the location and condition of the victim(s), and elapsed time since the accident occurred.
4. Make the General Area Safe
    a. Establish a hazard zone perimeter 50 feet around the tree.
        i. Keep all non-essential rescue personnel out of the hazard zone.
        ii. Remove all non-essential civilian personnel at least 150 feet away from the tree.

5. Make the Rescue Area Safe
    a. Maintain awareness of all electrical lines in the vicinity.
    b. Watch for falling debris, branches, or tree skirt that can become particularly problematic during windy conditions.
    c. Identify any other hazards that are present and ensure they are secured and made safe.

II. RESCUE OPERATIONS

1. Rescue
    a. Rescue responsibilities shall include the following:
        i. Ensure that all personnel operating in Rescue are accounted for and wearing appropriate PPE.
        ii. Develop a rescue plan and a back-up plan.
        iii. Ensure the plan and back-up plan, which include emergency procedures, are communicated to all personnel operating on the incident.
2. The Rescue Plan
    a. Rescue operations should be conducted with as little risk to the rescuers as necessary to affect the rescue. Low-risk operations may not always be possible but should be considered first.
    b. The order of rescue from low-risk to high-risk are:
        i. Self-rescue
            1. If possible, talk the victim into self-rescue. Place a ground ladder or aerial platform ladder under the victim and then coach the victim to climb down.
        ii. Ground Ladders
            1. Ground ladders should be placed against the tree. The first ladder should go under the victim; the second ladder should go along side and slightly above the victim. Both ladders should be secured to the tree. A piece of webbing or small piece of rope works well for securing the ladder to the tree.
        iii. Climb the Tree
            1. Tree climbing will not be done alone. Rescue staff will only climb ladders to help patients. Consider that it may be necessary to remove fronds or branches from the tree to reach the victim and that tree climbing is a high-risk operation.
        iv. Assess the Victim
            1. When the rescuers reach the victim a primary survey shall be completed and a determination as to the exact method of entrapment must be made. If the victim is conscious, rescuers should determine

if the victim can assist in the rescue. If the victim is unconscious, the rescue must be completed quickly.

v. Rescue the Victim
   1. One rescuer should climb above and to the side of the victim and establish a point of attachment for a lowering system. At the same time the other rescuer should climb to the victim and attach or "capture" the victim onto an approved rescue harness. On the ground an approved and appropriate anchor and lowering system shall be established. Once the lowering system has been attached the victim shall be disentangled from the tree that may include cutting away any system the victim used to climb the tree and lowered to the ground.

vi. Treatment
   2. Complete a secondary survey on the victim.
   3. Provide for BLS level treatment and transportation to a hospital as indicated.

III. TERMINATION

1. Ensure personnel accountability.
2. Recover all tools and equipment used in the rescue/recovery. In cases of a fatality consider leaving everything in place until the investigative process has been completed.
3. Consider a Post Incident Critique (may be more appropriate at a later date).
4. Return to service after returning all equipment to apparatus.

IV. ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

1. Command Structure
   a. The first arriving unit shall assume Command of the incident. This unit shall remain in Command until Command is transferred to improve the quality of the Command.

V. OTHER CONSIDERATIONS

1. Consider the effects of inclement weather on the hazard profile, the victim(s), and the rescuers.
2. Tree rescue incidents attract the news media; consider assigning a PIO

Freeway incidents commonly involve multiple vehicles, multiple patients, and often vehicle fires. A major potential also exists for flammable liquid spills, fires or hazardous materials incidents.

This plan provides specific information and procedures to be used in handling incidents occurring on the freeway system. Unless specifically superseded by this plan, all other Calimesa Fire Department procedures shall be used in operations occurring on freeways.

DISPATCH INFORMATION

When dispatching an incident on a freeway, Dispatch will provide the following information:

1. Type of Incident
2. Location
    a. Freeway or access frontage
    b. I-10
    c. Cross street
3. Direction of Travel
    a. If information indicates difficulty can be expected in reaching or locating the scene.
4. Traffic Conditions (if known)

RESPONSE

Dispatch may receive information on a freeway incident from Caltrans or a variety of other sources.

In most cases, the California Highway Patrol will report a freeway incident. Additionally, CHP may arrive first at an incident and may be able to provide updated information on traffic conditions and access. Any Information received from CHP must be relayed immediately to responding fire companies.

The Company Officer on a responding unit is responsible for redirecting other engines or having the Dispatch Center send additional engines if it becomes apparent that the first engine will be unable to reach the incident due to traffic congestion. If access problems are anticipated, or if the direction of travel is unknown, the Dispatch Center may send companies from opposite directions.

CANCELLED EN ROUTE

When responding to freeway emergencies and CHP is on-scene and has assumed command, it will be the responsibility of the CHP.

If fire units are canceled en route, they should not proceed into the scene unless re-dispatched. This creates unnecessary congestion and other traffic problems at the scene.

APPROACH AND STAGING

Units responding to calls on the Freeway will respond Code 3 while on the Freeway mainline. However, alternating headlights and rear flashers may be used. Units should attempt to reach the scene in the direction of the reported incident unless otherwise instructed by CHP

In some cases, CHP may advise the best access is via the access frontage or by traveling against the normal traffic flow. Units should proceed in the opposite direction of normal flow only at the specific request of CHP when it is assured that all traffic has been stopped. Fire units should confirm traffic is stopped before entering the freeway against traffic.

On multiple unit responses, the first unit approaching or entering the freeway within a mile of the incident will report its identity, location and direction. Other units approaching will then stage preferably near an on-ramp to avoid premature commitment to the mainline or access frontage. Where appropriate to do so, these companies may block the access road to prevent additional traffic from entering the freeway.

It is the responsibility of the first unit to direct other units via alternate access if unable to reach the scene. Specific directions should be given regarding approach and direction for other companies when problems are encountered.

COMMAND

The first unit arriving on the scene of a multiple unit incident will determine if the CHP has established a Command Post. If Incident Command is in place, the first arriving fire department unit shall meet with the CHP Incident Commander for a briefing. The following should be covered:

1. Traffic Conditions
    a. Stopped
    b. One lane open
    c. All lanes open
2. Fire/No Fire (smoke showing, working fire, fully involved) A follow-up report should indicate: